MUHAMMAD SALEEM, CHRMP

Dubai, UAE | +971 50 642 3966 | saleemawanhrd@gmail.com | Website | LinkedIn | Visa: UAE Employment

Professional Summary

HR Business Partner and CHRMP & SHRM certified HR professional with over 13 years of experience across the UAE and Pakistan, spanning retail, hospitality, restaurant, construction, BPO, ITC, and FMCG sectors. Proven track record of building HR functions from the ground up, including HRMS/HRIS implementation across five organizations, full-cycle talent acquisition, performance management systems, employee relations, and UAE labor law and government compliance (MOHRE, GDRFA, DED). Experienced in scaling HR infrastructure across multi-site, multi-vertical operations, improving employee retention, reducing time-to-hire, and digitizing manual HR processes into standardized, compliant systems.

Work Experience

Human Resources Specialist — **Dubai, UAE**

Nazih Group of Companies — Oct 2024 – Present

- Manage end-to-end HR operations for the UAE business, including payroll processing, full-cycle recruitment, onboarding, and employee lifecycle management.
- Designed and implemented a new OKR- and competency-based Performance Management System, rolled out across the organization.
- Manage employee probation cycles, tracking, performance feedback, confirmation, and extensions.
- Handle employee grievances, investigations, and resolutions in accordance with company policy and UAE Labor Law.
- Oversee HRMS/HRIS operations, maintaining accurate employee records, contracts, leave, attendance, and performance data.
- Manage all government and visa processes, including Emirates ID, MOHRE, GDRFA, ILOE, medical examinations, entry permits, transfers, and cancellations.
- Liaise with Dubai Municipality, DED, and Free Zone authorities for company licensing, renewals, and regulatory compliance.
- Prepare HR documentation including offer letters, employment contracts, confirmation letters, warning letters, NOCs, and salary certificates.

HR Business Partner / Generalist (formerly Senior Executive HR) — **Lahore, Pakistan**

Defence Raya Golf & Country Club — Nov 2017 – Sep 2024

- Joined as part of the pre-opening team for a large-scale mixed-use development spanning housing society, high-rise construction, golf, hospitality, and restaurant operations, with no existing HR infrastructure in place.
- Built the HR function from the ground up, leading an initial hiring drive of 400 employees and scaling further as the project expanded, growing the function to manage over 800 employees.
- Implemented an HRMS that reduced manual HR work by 60%, standardizing recruitment, onboarding, payroll, and performance management onto one system across all business verticals.
- Reduced time-to-hire from 15 days to 7 days by streamlining recruitment workflows and approval processes.
- Ran employee engagement surveys, exit interviews, and leadership development programs, helping maintain staff retention at around 95%.
- Designed and implemented HR policies, SOPs, and grievance-handling processes across housing, golf, hospitality, and construction divisions.
- Partnered with senior management on organizational restructuring and workforce planning during a period of rapid, multi-site growth.

HR Consultant

Independent Practice — From 2020

- Provided HR consulting services to clients across retail, hospitality, restaurants, and technology.
- Designed HR systems, policy manuals, salary structures, organizational design, and compliance processes to support client growth.

HR Generalist — **Lahore, Pakistan**

EPIC Consulting Group — Jul 2017 – Nov 2017

- Streamlined group-wide payroll and HR operations, managing compensation & benefits, final settlements, reporting, and employee documentation.
- Designed and implemented a Performance Management System from scratch, including training staff on adoption.
- Delivered outsourced HR and administrative services to 3 client organizations, including Huawei (2,000 employees), Albayrak, and Shahid Builders.

Senior Executive Human Resources — **Lahore, Pakistan**

Bundu Khan Foods — Jan 2016 – Jun 2017

- Joined as the first HR hire, establishing the HR function from the ground up with no prior HR infrastructure.
- Built and implemented a complete HR manual and policy framework from zero, and rolled out an HRMS to digitize employee records and processes.
- Played a key role in scaling the company from 11 to over 50 branches, building standardized recruitment, performance management, and compliance systems across restaurant, bakery, and factory operations.

Senior Executive Human Resources **Lahore, Pakistan**

Gourmet Pakistan Jan 2014 – Dec 2015

- Supported HR leadership in scaling the company from 85 to over 250 branches, helping implement standardized HR infrastructure, recruitment, and performance management systems.
- Managed payroll processing and attendance for over 25 branches, and led recruitment across restaurant, bakery, and factory operations.
- Oversaw HR compliance audits, grievance handling, and HRMS-based attendance and performance tracking for frontline staff.

Human Resources Officer **Lahore, Pakistan**

Gourmet Pakistan Jan 2013 – Dec 2013

- Managed branch-wise attendance and payroll processes for a workforce of over 10,000 employees across 250+ shops, including UK operations.
- Supported HRMS implementation alongside senior HR teams, contributing to digitizing attendance and employee records at group level.
- Handled employee documentation, final settlements, and hiring verification for shop-level staff.

Core Skills

HR Operations & Systems: HR Operations, HRMS/HRIS Implementation (5x), Payroll, Employee Data Management, HR Analytics, Compliance & Risk Management

Talent & Performance: Talent Acquisition, Full-Cycle Recruitment & Onboarding, Performance Management (PMS/OKR), Learning & Development, Organizational Development

Partnering & Rewards: HR Business Partnering, Employee Relations, People Management, Compensation & Benefits, Employee Engagement, HR Policies & Manuals

UAE Compliance: UAE Labor Law, MOHRE, GDRFA, Emirates ID, Visa & PRO Processing, Trade Licensing, DED & Free Zone Coordination

Leadership & Advisory: HR Strategy, Coaching & Mentoring, Conflict Resolution, Negotiation, Workforce Planning, Business Communication

Education

University of the Punjab **Lahore, Pakistan**

Master's in Human Resource Management

Certifications & Languages

Certifications: CHRMP, SHRM, HRCI, HR Analytics, HR Business Partner, Performance Management, Compensation & Benefits, Talent Management, Recruiting Foundations, plus 10 LinkedIn Learning HR Certifications

Languages: English, Urdu, Punjabi, Hindi, Kashmiri